

# Annual Report 2025

National Recovery Plan for the Koala *Phascolarctos cinereus*  
(combined populations of Queensland, New South Wales and the  
Australian Capital Territory)

**December 2025**



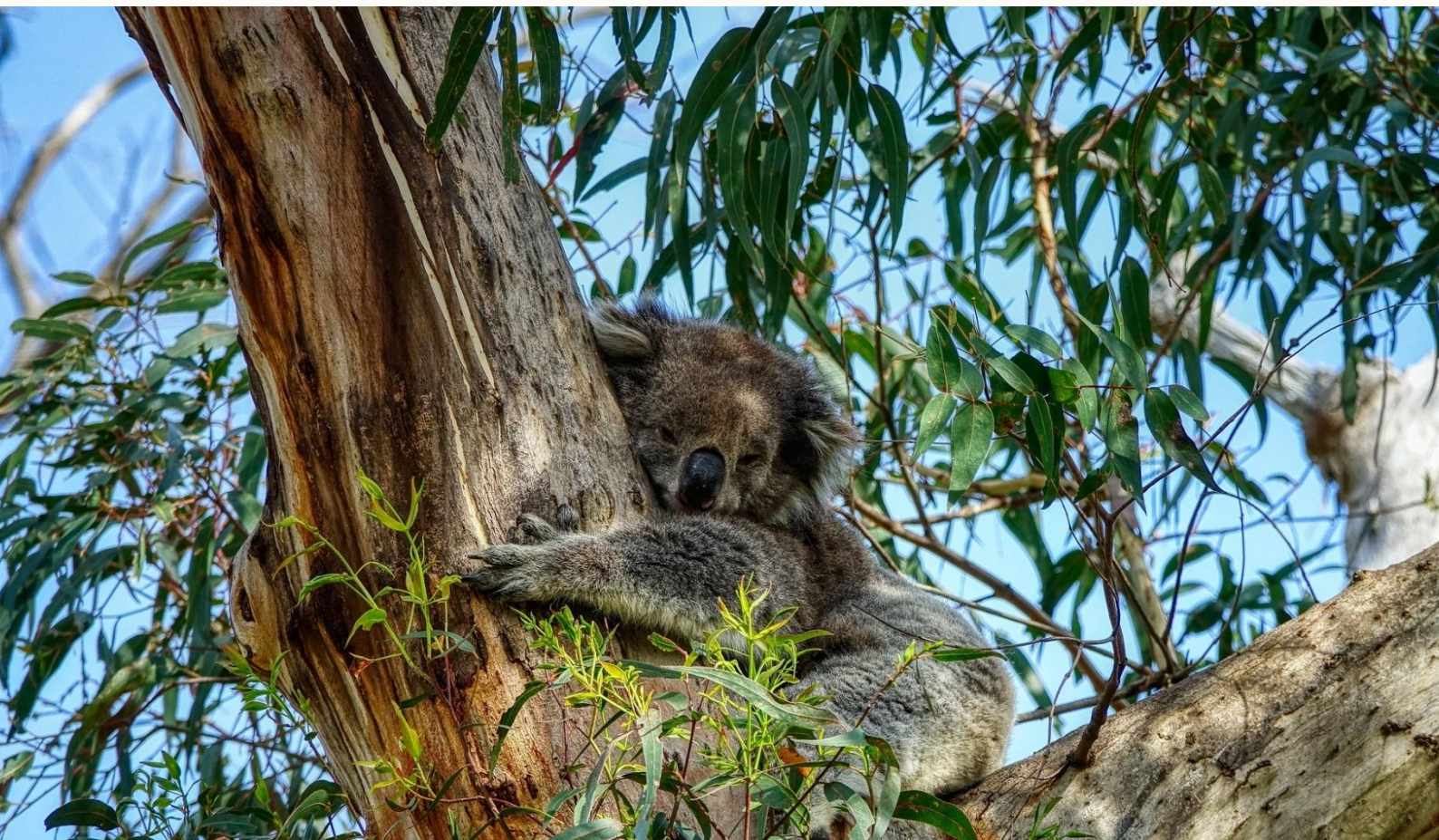


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The National Koala Recovery Team acknowledges the Traditional Owners of Country in Australia and their continuing connection to land, sea, and community. We pay our respects to them and their cultures and to their elders both past and present.

We are committed to working respectfully with First Nations peoples and acknowledge their use, knowledge and custodianship of Australia's native plants and animals, including the koala over countless generations. We support First Nations peoples and their aspirations to maintain, protect and manage their culture, language, land and sea, and heritage.



# Foreword

On behalf of the National Koala Recovery Team Board, I present the third annual report of the National Koala Recovery Plan for the Koala *Phascolarctos cinereus* (combined populations of Queensland, New South Wales and the Australian Capital Territory).

On commencing in this role, I was impressed to see the amount of on-ground work underway to support koalas, as well as the breadth and depth of intelligence gathering to underpin future decisions. I was also impressed by the depth of commitment to koalas shown by community groups, research institutions, Regional Delivery Partners and governments in the design and delivery of koala recovery initiatives.

This last reporting period has been an important one for building our understanding of koala populations and some of the threats that are affecting them. Recent information has significantly advanced these efforts. While a lot of work has been done, there remains many challenges for koala recovery that require our collective effort and attention.

My sincere thanks go to those contributing their time and expertise to the recovery of the koala. I commend this report to your reading and look forward to a continued collective effort to support the ongoing survival of koalas in the wild.



**Jackie Raynor**  
**Chair, National Koala Recovery Team**

# 1. Introduction

In February 2022<sup>1</sup>, the koala (combined populations of Queensland, New South Wales and the Australian Capital Territory) was listed as endangered. In April 2022, the National Recovery Plan for the Koala *Phascolarctos cinereus* (combined populations of Queensland, New South Wales and the Australian Capital Territory) (recovery plan) was published, setting a pathway for koala recovery action over a 10-year timeframe.

In October 2022, the first national recovery team for the koala was established, bringing together First Nations people, government, community groups, non-government organisations (NGOs) and scientists with a common purpose: to stop the decline in the population size of the listed koala. The recovery team structure represents the broad interest in koalas across the conservation community. The team commits to best-practice approaches to governance, data-sharing, and transparency.

This 2025 annual report for the recovery plan considers progress on the implementation of the recovery plan for the period May 2024 to May 2025, as well as what has been achieved since the plan was published in 2022. This report also includes recently published updates to the national koala population estimate and modelling of koala habitat in a changing climate. While outside the normal reporting window, these 2 items are included because of the direct relevance and importance of timely communications to support ongoing recovery efforts.

This report also documents progress against each of the 6 strategies in the recovery plan, covering all 37 actions. It shows the significant and concerted effort by governments, conservation organisations and the community to reverse the decline of this iconic species.

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<sup>1</sup> Department of Agriculture, Water and the Environment (2022) Conservation Advice for *Phascolarctos cinereus* (Koala) combined populations of Queensland, New South Wales and the Australian Capital Territory, Attachment A: Listing Assessment for *Phascolarctos cinereus* combined populations of Queensland, New South Wales and the Australian Capital Territory. Canberra.



## 2. Summary assessment of progress

### Assessment of state/condition and trajectory

Table 1. Conservation assessment

|                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                      |                                                                                                               |
|--------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>EPBC Act Status</b>                     | <b>Endangered</b>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                      |                                                                                                               |
| <b>Recovery plan</b>                       | <a href="#">National Recovery Plan for the Koala <i>Phascolarctos cinereus</i> (combined populations of Queensland, New South Wales and the Australian Capital Territory)</a>                                                                                                                                    |                      |                                                                                                               |
| <b>Listed range</b>                        |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                |                      |                                                                                                               |
| <b>State/condition<sup>2</sup></b>         |                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <b>Poor</b>          |  <b>Limited consensus</b> |
|                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                      |  <b>Limited evidence</b>  |
| <b>Conservation trajectory<sup>3</sup></b> |                                                                                                                                                                                                                               | <b>Deteriorating</b> |  <b>Limited consensus</b> |
|                                            |                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  |                      |  <b>Limited evidence</b>  |
| <b>Further information</b>                 | Website: <a href="http://www.dcceew.gov.au/environment/biodiversity/threatened/species/koalas/national-koala-recovery">www.dcceew.gov.au/environment/biodiversity/threatened/species/koalas/national-koala-recovery</a><br>Email: <a href="mailto:Koala.recovery@dcceew.gov.au">Koala.recovery@dcceew.gov.au</a> |                      |                                                                                                               |

## Statement on the conservation trajectory of the koala

At the time of listing as endangered, there were estimated to be approximately 90,000 mature individual koalas, across Queensland (QLD), New South Wales (NSW) and the Australian Capital Territory (ACT), with a contracting trend. Koalas were estimated to occur across over 160,000,000 hectares with a contracting trend, and actively occupying over 1,900,000 hectares (within that area) with a contracting trend. Over 10 subpopulations were listed, with a declining trend as climate-suitable koala habitat shrinks.<sup>2</sup>

Under the recovery plan, significant investment and work has occurred to strengthen the understanding of national listed koala populations and estimates. This has led to new information about population size and the threats to koala recovery.

New updates to the National Koala Monitoring Program (NKMP)<sup>3</sup> population estimate suggests a significantly larger population size. The 2025 NKMP estimate is good news for koalas, however it does not provide evidence of a positive population trajectory but rather increased accuracy from incorporating new data.

The koala was listed as endangered due to, among other factors, a population decline of more than 50% over 3 generations. This listing also took note of the significant koala mortality that would have occurred during the 2019-20 summer bushfires.

The new population estimate data identifies that the 'baseline' population of koalas is quite likely to be higher than previously estimated, and does create some uncertainty about the overall koala population status. This uncertainty is reflected in a changed trajectory confidence. Decisions about the listing status of the koala remain the responsibility of state and federal governments in accordance with relevant legislated processes.

The NKMP efforts to date have focussed on developing a robust and reliable estimate of the koala population to act as a 'baseline'. Over time, the NKMP will develop data-driven models of listed population trends. As this information becomes available the Board will take it into consideration and respond appropriately.

It is also important to acknowledge that the endangered koala population remains impacted by threats and pressures including:

- increased intensity and frequency of climate change impacts, including droughts, extreme temperatures and bushfires,
- a shrinking habitat due to climate change,
- disease, specifically koala retrovirus (KoRV) and chlamydia,
- habitat loss resulting from land clearing, and

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<sup>2</sup> Conservation Advice for *Phascolarctos cinereus* (Koala) combined populations of Queensland, New South Wales and the Australian capital Territory

<sup>3</sup> National Koala Monitoring Program

- mortality due to encounters with vehicles and dogs.

Known Koala Habitat in a Changing Climate (Known KHICC)<sup>4</sup> mapping illustrates areas of koala habitat likely to remain climatically suitable in 2070. Results indicate approximately 430,000 hectares (or 4%) of identified habitat in QLD and NSW is at risk of becoming climatically unsuitable for koalas.

Genetic research published by The University of Sydney shares the results of a fully mapped koala genome and highlights concerns about the genetic health of the population now and into the future (McLennan, 2024).

### Koala population estimate

Investment and collaboration on the NKMP is providing data and improving modelling to help inform our understanding of the state and condition of the koala across its range. CSIRO's data-driven population model has been built based on tens of thousands of data points, combining historic data with contemporary data from on-ground monitoring efforts.

Updated figures from modelling undertaken through the NKMP are outlined in **Table 2** below.

It is important to note that:

- the population range estimates are derived from data-driven models, which will be improved by collecting and analysing additional data over time.
- more data has been collected than ever before, with a total of 820 site surveys now completed by the NKMP, and 11,290 data points included in the model. New techniques like drone and acoustic monitoring are also improving detections.
- changes in the population estimates year-on-year do not indicate a change in actual koala populations; at this stage the 2025 estimate is still part of 'base-lining' our understanding of koala population size.

**Table 2.** NKMP data-driven model and refinement history <sup>5</sup>

| Estimate                               | Listed population range<br>(QLD, NSW, ACT) | Unlisted population range<br>(VIC, SA) |
|----------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| <b>NKMP 1st annual estimate (2023)</b> | <b>117,050 – 244,440</b>                   | <b>170,780 – 383,570</b>               |
| <b>NKMP 2nd annual estimate (2024)</b> | <b>95,000 – 238,000</b>                    | <b>129,000 – 286,000</b>               |
| <b>NKMP 3rd annual estimate (2025)</b> | <b>398,000 – 569,000</b>                   | <b>303,000 – 381,000</b>               |

<sup>4</sup> [Known Koala Habitat in a Changing Climate](#)

<sup>5</sup> For more information on the NKMP go to: <https://www.nkmp.org.au/populations.php>.



## Delivery highlights

The delivery of the recovery plan continues to draw on a wide range of input and interests including national, state and territory governments, First Nations peoples, NGOs, researchers, wildlife carers and community groups. The recovery team continued to meet to share knowledge through meetings, field visits and expert speakers, as highlighted through Board communiques.

Since the last annual report, the Queensland Government has committed an additional \$28.7 million to support koala recovery actions. This brings the total government investment in koala recovery since 2021 in QLD, ACT and NSW alone to nearly \$500 million. This number is higher when including NGO initiatives and funding for unlisted koalas that is supporting habitat restoration, protection, threat mitigation and health initiatives since the recovery team was established.

The last 12 months has also seen the advancement of a number of longer-term knowledge projects, providing vital information and baseline information that can be drawn upon over the life of the plan, to guide action and measure progress.

## Koala Habitat in a Changing Climate

The Australian Government developed the Known KHICCs, a map highlighting the impacts that climate change may have on the extent of suitable koala habitat in the near future.

Building on the Nationally Important Koala Areas map developed in 2021 by the National Environmental Science Program, the Known KHICCs reflect areas of likely koala presence and koala feed habitat, and overlaps this with climate change models to predict whether habitat remains suitable in 2070.

The Known KHICCs support strategy one (build and share knowledge) of the recovery plan and grows the knowledge base that decision makers can draw upon when considering which actions to take to recover koalas.

## Genomics research

Newly published research from The University of Sydney provides an important insight into the genetic composition of koalas across Australia. Based on the complete mapping of the koala genome, the research provides valuable insight into current genetic diversity in koala populations, and analysis of genetic flow across the listed population. The paper is open access and accessible at [Genomics identifies koala populations at risk across eastern Australia](#).

This new knowledge also supports strategy one of the recovery plan and grows the knowledge base that decision makers can draw upon when considering which actions to take to recover koalas.

## National research principles

Delivering on action 1h (establish national research priorities) in the recovery plan, the *National Koala Research Principles* provides guidance on research best placed to support the recovery of the koala.

The recovery team has not endorsed a prescriptive set of research topics, given there will be differing research needs in different contexts and at different scales. The recovery team does however acknowledge that detailed research needs are set out in the [NSW Koala Research Plan 2019-2028](#), and have been identified by other research institutions and koala conservation groups.

The recovery team considers research for the nationally listed koala should be prioritised based on alignment with the newly published *National Koala Research Principles*, available at [dcceew.gov.au](http://dcceew.gov.au), to best support koala recovery.

## Delivery risks

Successful implementation of the recovery plan continues to be challenged by a range of risks. The National Koala Recovery Team Board has developed a risk framework to address risks. The framework includes process-based risks such as lack of stakeholder coordination, as well as threat-based risks such as habitat loss and wildfire. Controls are identified for each risk, and these are typically the responsibility of a number of stakeholders. The Board regularly monitors risks and identifies where additional treatments may be required.

Over the last 12 months, some specific risks have arisen with implications for recovery plan delivery. This included further significant weather events in QLD and NSW that have been impacting on koala habitat restoration efforts and potentially on koalas themselves. The recovery team has commissioned Wildlife Health Australia to develop guidance for managing koalas during natural disasters, improving welfare outcomes for individual koalas. The Board also includes natural disasters as a focus of ongoing risk and opportunities tracking to allow timely responses to emerging information.

Delays also persist in firming up the national koala population estimate due to koala survey data sharing challenges, including alignment of data delivery timelines. This work is being progressed by Commonwealth Scientific and Industrial Research Organisation (CSIRO) through the NKMP. CSIRO has worked closely with the relevant agencies to progress data sharing agreements, and undertaken mitigation actions to collect additional data where possible to firm up estimates.

Threat-based risks to the listed koala's recovery, such as habitat clearance and disease, are ongoing. Actions to address these are included in the recovery plan, and will require continued collaboration, resourcing and effort.

Overall, effective and efficient governance of the recovery team also remains a priority of the Board. This ensures:

- action to recover the endangered koala is coordinated and prioritised,
- recovery team operations avoid burnout, and
- consultation fatigue in stakeholders is prevented.

### 3. Recovery plan goal and objectives

The goal of the recovery plan is to stop the trend of decline in population size of the listed koala. Measuring progress towards this goal (Table 1) will only be possible in 5 to 10 year intervals because long-term data is needed to assess trends.

The objectives of the recovery plan are over 10 years (Table 2), and there may appear to be limited progress in the early years of the recovery plan for the same reason. The data needed to assess progress takes time to collect and analyse.

Information in the tables below provides a qualitative assessment of progress against the recovery plan goal and objectives.

**Table 1:** Progress towards the goal of the National Recovery Plan for the Koala

| Goal                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     | Comments                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| To stop the trend of decline in population size of the listed koala, by having resilient, connected, and genetically healthy metapopulations across its range, and to increase the extent, quality and connectivity of habitat occupied. | Significant investment and effort have been committed by governments which contributes to delivery of the National Recovery Plan for the Koala. This includes \$365 million to support koala recovery in NSW, the Australian Government's \$76.9 million Saving Koalas, and the \$28.7 million South East Queensland Koala Conservation Strategy. This investment is supporting activities such as koala survey and monitoring, habitat restoration, health research and threat management. While these investments will have a positive impact over time, it is too premature to see the environmental impact. The state and condition of listed koalas for this report remains poor and declining until the investments can improve the trajectory of koalas over generations. |



**Table 2:** Progress towards the objectives of the recovery plan for the koala including status indicators

*Objective metrics:*



Objective at high risk of not being met



Insufficient action, objective at risk of not being met



Some progress has been made towards this objective



Substantial progress has been made towards this objective



Objective nearly achieved



Criteria met; objective achieved

| Recovery plan objectives/criteria                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Comments                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Status                                                                                               |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>Objective 1a</b></p> <p>The area of occupancy and estimated size of populations that are declining, suspected to be declining, or predicted to decline are instead stabilised then increased.</p> <p><b>Performance Criteria</b></p> <p>By 2032,</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>indices of population size (abundance) of a representative sample of populations show that population size has increased</li> <li>the area of occupancy of a representative sample of populations has increased</li> <li>the area and quality of refugial habitat of populations whose primary threat is climate change, and indirectly drought and heatwaves, has increased.</li> </ul> | <p>Results from the NKMP and state-based initiatives are improving our understanding of koala population numbers and area of occupation across the listed range. Ongoing investment and collaboration in this program will improve the evidence available to assess population status and trend over time.</p> <p>Establishing ‘baselines’ for this objective and associated performance criteria is a key task to allow for interim reporting at the 5-year recovery plan review, and for final reporting in 2032. The 2025 koala population estimates are supporting ‘baselining’ koala populations and will allow for assessment of trend over time.</p> | <br>Some progress |

| Recovery plan objectives/criteria                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            | Comments                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          | Status                                                                                                   |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>Objective 1b</b></p> <p>The area of occupancy and estimated size of populations that are suspected and predicted to be stable are maintained or increased.</p> <p><b>Performance Criteria</b></p> <p>By 2032,</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>indices of population size (abundance) of a representative sample of populations show that population size are maintained or increased</li> <li>the area of occupancy of a representative sample of populations is maintained or increased.</li> </ul> <p><b>Performance Criteria (1a and 1b)</b></p> <p>By 2032,</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>across all representative populations, there is a total net increase of habitat (excluding offset areas) five-yearly.</li> </ul> | <p>Results from the NKMP and state-based initiatives are improving our understanding of koala population numbers and area of occupation across the listed range.</p> <p>Establishing 'baselines' for this objective and associated performance criteria is a key task to allow for interim reporting at the 5-year recovery plan review, and for final reporting in 2032. The 2025 koala population estimates are supporting 'baselining' koala populations and will allow for assessment of trend over time.</p> |  <p>Some progress</p> |
| <p><b>Objective 2</b></p> <p>Metapopulation processes are maintained or improved.</p> <p><b>Performance Criteria</b></p> <p>By 2032,</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>indicators of population health (genetic and disease) are maintained or improved</li> <li>indicators of ecosystem health are maintained or improved.</li> </ul>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | <p>Work is continuing on exploration of suitable koala health indicators and ecosystem health as part of the NKMP.</p> <p>Establishing 'baselines' for this objective and the performance criteria is a key task to allow for interim reporting at the 5-year recovery plan review, and for final reporting in 2032.</p> <p>Advancements in genetic understanding is helping to 'baseline' genetic diversity and will allow for assessment of trend over time.</p>                                                |  <p>Some progress</p> |

| Recovery plan objectives/criteria                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | Comments                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   | Status                                                                                                                                              |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p><b>Objective 3</b></p> <p>Partners, communities, and individuals have a greater role and capability in listed koala monitoring, conservation, and management.</p> <p><b>Performance Criteria</b></p> <p>By 2032,</p> <ul style="list-style-type: none"> <li>• there is an increase in the number, locations and activities of Indigenous Australians participating in recovery for the listed koala, including leadership, agenda setting, citizen science, training and capacity building and on-ground works across the range of the listed koala</li> <li>• there is an increase in the number, locations and activities of the general community participating in recovery for the listed koala, including leadership, agenda setting, citizen science, training and capacity building and on-ground works</li> <li>• there is an increase in the number, locations and activities of the partners participating in recovery for the listed koala, including leadership, agenda setting, citizen science, training and capacity building and on-ground works across the range of the listed koala.</li> </ul> | <p>There are hundreds of organisations involved in koala conservation across the listed range, including First Nations groups, Landcare, wildlife care, local governments, regional Natural Resource Management (NRM) organisations, researchers, community groups, wildlife advocacy groups and NGOs.</p> | <div data-bbox="1691 167 1930 215">  </div> <p>Some progress</p> |

## 4. Implementing actions

The indicators are arranged according to the 6 strategies of the recovery plan:

1. Build and share knowledge
2. Engage and partner with the community in listed koala conservation
3. Increase the area of protected habitat for the listed koala
4. Integrate listed koala conservation into policy, statutory and land use plans
5. Strategically restore listed koala habitat
6. Actively manage listed koala metapopulations.

A summary of progress against each recovery plan strategy is provided in Table 3. The status indicators show progress against each action that makes up each recovery plan strategy. It is important to note, with so many koala management activities underway, these summaries are not representative of actions by all stakeholders, instead highlighting a few key examples progressed by the recovery team. It is recognised that some organisations and individuals also undertake advocacy work to support koala conservation. While this may not be reflected in specific recovery plan actions, it nonetheless contributes to recovery efforts.

Actions taken outside of the listed koala range, for example in Victoria or South Australia, are not included in this annual report unless they contribute more broadly to an understanding of koala metapopulations, distribution and health, or national standards.



Table 3: Overview of status indicators for each action in the recovery plan<sup>6</sup>

| STRATEGY 1                |                                                                    | STRATEGY 2                                                          |                                                                    | STRATEGY 3                                                 |                                                                    | STRATEGY 4                                                                    |                                                                    | STRATEGY 5                                  |                                                                    | STRATEGY 6                                   |                                                                    |
|---------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Build and share knowledge |                                                                    | Engage and partner with the community in listed koala conservation. |                                                                    | Increase the area of protected habitat for the list koala. |                                                                    | Integrate listed koala conservation into policy, statutory and land use plans |                                                                    | Strategically restored listed koala habitat |                                                                    | Actively manage listed koala metapopulations |                                                                    |
| Action                    | Status                                                             | Action                                                              | Status                                                             | Action                                                     | Status                                                             | Action                                                                        | Status                                                             | Action                                      | Status                                                             | Action                                       | Status                                                             |
| 1a                        | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | 2a                                                                  | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | 3a                                                         | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | 4a                                                                            | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | 5a                                          | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | 6a                                           | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> |
| 1b                        | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | 2b                                                                  | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | 3b                                                         | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | 4b                                                                            | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | 5b                                          | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | 6b                                           | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> |
| 1c                        | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | 2c                                                                  | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | 3c                                                         | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | 4c                                                                            | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | 5c                                          | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | 6c                                           | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> |
| 1d                        | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | 2d                                                                  | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> |                                                            |                                                                    | 4d                                                                            | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | 5d                                          | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | 6d                                           | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> |
| 1e                        | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | 2e                                                                  | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> |                                                            |                                                                    | 4e                                                                            | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> |                                             |                                                                    | 6e                                           | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> |
| 1f                        | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | 2f                                                                  | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> |                                                            |                                                                    |                                                                               |                                                                    |                                             |                                                                    |                                              |                                                                    |
| 1g                        | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | 2g                                                                  | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> |                                                            |                                                                    |                                                                               |                                                                    |                                             |                                                                    |                                              |                                                                    |
| 1h                        | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> | 2h                                                                  | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> |                                                            |                                                                    |                                                                               |                                                                    |                                             |                                                                    |                                              |                                                                    |
| 1i                        | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> |                                                                     |                                                                    |                                                            |                                                                    |                                                                               |                                                                    |                                             |                                                                    |                                              |                                                                    |
| 1j                        | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> |                                                                     |                                                                    |                                                            |                                                                    |                                                                               |                                                                    |                                             |                                                                    |                                              |                                                                    |
| 1k                        | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> |                                                                     |                                                                    |                                                            |                                                                    |                                                                               |                                                                    |                                             |                                                                    |                                              |                                                                    |
| 1l                        | <div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div><div></div></div> |                                                                     |                                                                    |                                                            |                                                                    |                                                                               |                                                                    |                                             |                                                                    |                                              |                                                                    |

No progress

Limited progress

Some progress

Substantial progress

Nearing completion

Complete

Status change since 2024

<sup>6</sup> A description of each action is described below.

## Strategy 1 – Build and share knowledge

These actions involve knowledge-based inputs or activities that support direct actions in the recovery plan. They will provide information for a strategic and coordinated approach to conservation for the listed koala.

### Progress

The knowledge base and science available to guide recovery actions continues to grow.

Known KHICC mapping has been developed, highlighting the known range of climate-resilient populations and habitat. Significant updates were also made to habitat data for south-east Queensland (SEQ), including revised Areas of Regional Koala Significance (ARKS). A partnership between Queensland Government and the regional NRM organisation Healthy Land and Water is also advancing Koala Priority Threat Area maps. The NSW 'Koalas in the Landscape' report was published mapping landscape capacity.

Monitoring and research programs continued. The NKMP has surveyed over 800 sites and increased the deployment of audio recording devices. Jurisdictional monitoring efforts of listed populations continued in NSW (state-wide) and the ACT (100 sites). In QLD, the SEQ Koala Monitoring Program has conducted surveys at 227 sites ranging in size from 7 to 396 hectares.

National Koala Research Principles were published to assist in targeting research to local priorities, given the varied regional needs for koala research, completing Action 1h.

Collaboration continues through forums like the NSW Koala Aboriginal Advisory Panel, the NKMP Community of Practice, the recovery team Community Advisory Committee, and koala focused summits in NSW, ACT, and SEQ. QLD and ACT both hosted workshops specifically to advance its First Nations knowledge transfer.

### Next steps

Both 'baselining' population estimates to track trajectory, and understanding the unique threats and priorities at regional scales, remains important.

The NSW Government will continue statewide 'baseline' koala surveys, priority population monitoring and the Sentinel program, including genetic sampling and the revision of ARKS. The Australian Government will continue to refine the Known KHICC layers and the ACT will finalise its multi-year 'baseline' monitoring and establish a strategic plan for ongoing efforts.

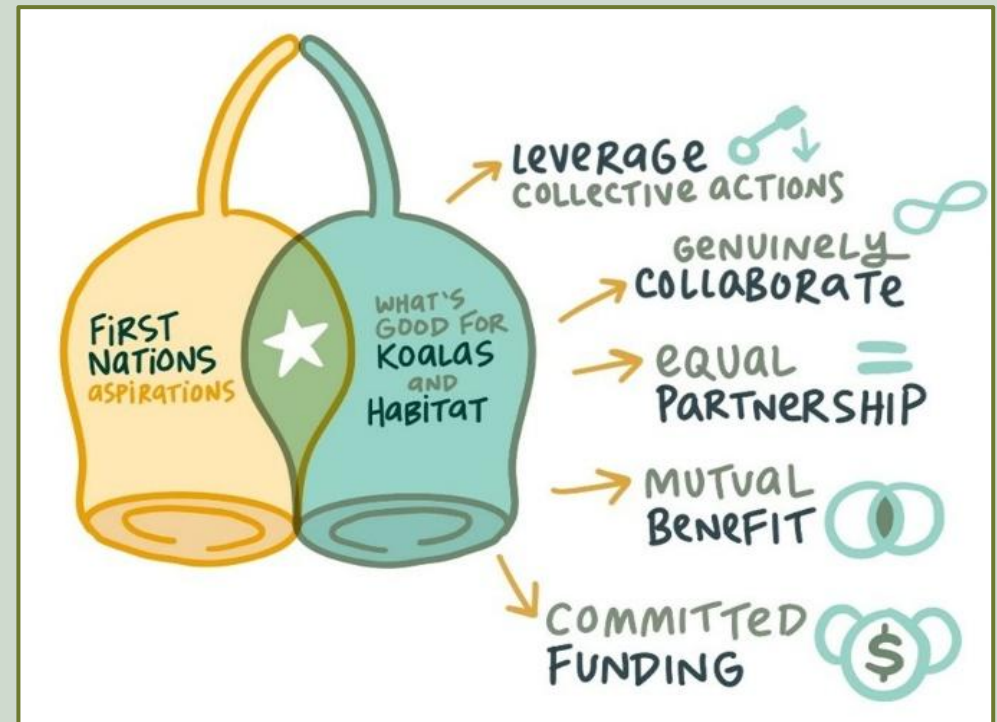
| Status                                                                                | Action | Description                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|    | 1a     | Identify nationally important populations and habitat for recovery across the listed koala range under current and future conditions                                                                                                                                     |
|    | 1b     | Identify spatially and temporally strategic areas of high priority for: (a) restoration and revegetation based on koala and eucalypt population viability; (b) climate and fire refugia; and; (c) corridors facilitating movement and metapopulation processes of koalas |
|    | 1c     | Develop prioritisation at regional or other appropriate scales for the long-term implementation of actions                                                                                                                                                               |
|    | 1d     | Establish a fit-for-purpose long-term NKMP                                                                                                                                                                                                                               |
|    | 1e     | Implement NKMP and review design                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|    | 1f     | Review mapping of key metrics                                                                                                                                                                                                                                            |
|    | 1g     | Coordinate and improve data management and standards                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|  | 1h     | Establish national research priorities                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|  | 1i     | Establish national-level recurring koala forums                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |
|  | 1j     | Establish and support an active National Koala Recovery Team                                                                                                                                                                                                             |
|  | 1k     | Share knowledge through regular koala workshops, including a national koala conference                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|  | 1l     | Facilitate transfer of traditional knowledge on the koala                                                                                                                                                                                                                |

## Facilitating the transfer of indigenous knowledge

Koalas have cultural significance to many different indigenous groups. In the last 12 months, regional ties between indigenous groups in QLD have been strengthened to ensure traditional knowledge of the koala is passed on to new generations and lessons about managing the koala can be shared between Traditional Owners.

In March 2025, representatives from 11 First Nations organisations from the SEQ region met on Turrbal Country for a Department of the Environment, Tourism, Science and Innovation workshop to discuss important issues for koalas. Topics discussed included participation in on Country surveys, the role of cultural burning to maintain healthy habitat, access to data and mapping, First Nations' input into broader policies and many more complex holistic issues around managing Country and valuing cultural knowledge.

Connections and relationships built and strengthened at the workshop will ensure there is a strong Indigenous voice championing koala conservation in SEQ going forward.



*Created on Turrbal Country by IndiDust.com*

## Strategy 2 – Engage and partner with the community in listed koala conservation

Successful conservation for the listed koala relies on collaboration across sectors and levels of government. Communities have a key role to play in protecting local koalas. These actions contribute to shared goals, from formal partnerships for habitat protection, to training professionals and community koala rehabilitation carers, to education and awareness raising.

### Progress

Partnerships for the recovery of the koala have expanded in the last 12 months.

Targeted actions were undertaken to reduce threats on koalas at the local level through information sharing with communities. In SEQ, a centralised online hub to facilitate access to conservation information and engagement tools is under development. This resource will support the community to understand environmental offsets. A stakeholder engagement strategy has also been developed.

Significant work is underway by local governments looking to mitigate local threats such as domestic dog impacts and road strikes. Additionally, the recovery team, led by Wildlife Health Australia, has made substantial progress on a guidance document for koala vaccination against chlamydia and begun a guidance for emergency management of koalas in natural disasters.

The NSW Government continues to work closely with 11 regional and Aboriginal partnerships under the NSW Koala Strategy, to improve conservation outcomes for koalas. The I Spy Koala application has been upgraded to provide an improved user experience, enabling community members to report koala sightings. The Koala Smart program also continues to be rolled out in NSW schools.

Innovative partnerships like the Koalas Friendly Carbon Initiative, developed by WWF Australia, are showing how private partnerships can restore koala habitat. Queensland Trust For Nature is expanding its partnership with the Queensland Government to deliver habitat protection and restoration through the Koala Habitat Restoration and the Restore and Reconnect programs.

### Next steps

Growth and strengthening of partnerships will continue. The NSW and Queensland governments will continue activities, enhancing community engagement on key behavioural threats like vehicle strike and dog attack. Nationally, the NKMP public data dashboard will continue to be updated to ensure it is user-friendly. The National Koala Recovery Team will progress action 2g by finalising guidance documents on chlamydia vaccination and management of koalas in natural disasters, coordinated by Wildlife Health Australia.

| Status                                                                                | Action | Description                                                                                                                                                      |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|    | 2a     | Grow partnerships for citizens to be involved in long-term koala monitoring programs and research                                                                |
|    | 2b     | Grow partnerships to restore priority areas of koala habitat                                                                                                     |
|    | 2c     | Develop active communication, education and extension strategies aimed at koala habitat protection, incentives, partnerships and compliance                      |
|    | 2d     | Integrate traditional ecological knowledge and vision, monitoring and land management practices with koala conservation, citizen science and research activities |
|    | 2e     | Implement a comprehensive communication strategy                                                                                                                 |
|   | 2f     | Develop a user-friendly single-site portal for the general public to report koala sightings                                                                      |
|  | 2g     | Facilitate coordination and national consistency in codes of practice for koala care, ethics, monitoring and compliance                                          |
|  | 2h     | Expand and build on existing community education and engagement programs in urban and peri-urban areas                                                           |



## South Australia Great Koala Count

Lessons from the unlisted populations on monitoring and management remain important for the listed koala. Learnings from unlisted populations are shared through Victorian and South Australian members of the National Koala Recovery Team.

The 2024 South Australia Great Koala Count, launched under the NKMP in partnership with Flinders University, has emerged as a landmark week-long citizen science initiative to increase understanding of unlisted koalas in South Australia.

This event was created to engage the public in koala research and empower South Australians to report koala sightings using the Koala Spotter application. The week kicked off with a public community event hosted at Belair National Park. Attendees learned about the role of citizen science in koala research, and how the NKMP coordinates with local koala monitoring organisations to build a national data set.

The event was a major success with 206 new members signed up to the Koala Spotter app and a total of 298 sightings submitted. The count enabled researchers to gather extensive data and was a great opportunity for members of the koala community to connect and exchange ideas.

The inclusion of data from citizen science into long term research and programs is a long-term aim under action 2a of the recovery plan. The success of the South Australia Great Koala Count has demonstrated the power of integrating citizen science into national environmental monitoring efforts. Through the NKMP's support and coordination, the initiative fostered public engagement, increased awareness of koala conservation issues, and strengthened the data available for long-term action.



### Strategy 3 – Increase the area of protected habitat for the listed koala

Increasing the total area of protected, connected quality koala habitat in priority areas will be important to protect and recover listed koala populations. This will require a range of incentive mechanisms, including direct land purchase. Improvements in land management practices can also increase habitat protection without changing land use.

#### Progress

Delivering on this strategy is a long-term commitment by governments, private landholders, NGOs and community groups. Over the life of the recovery plan, concerted restoration and revegetation efforts have helped to progress these actions.

In the last 12 months, progress has been made in several jurisdictions to protect habitat on private land and expand innovative incentive mechanisms. The Australian Government has launched the Nature Repair Market and published the first set of methodologies that outlines a framework for attracting investors and encouraging land management practices which improve biodiversity. The Queensland Government has invested in carbon farming projects in line with Action 2.4 (Invest in carbon farming projects that deliver koala outcomes as a priority) of the SEQ Koala Conservation Strategy. Progress has also been achieved in the past 12 months through direct action. NSW Department of Climate Change, Energy, the Environment and Water, in partnership with WWF and Biodiversity Conservation Trust (BCT), are protecting over 900 hectares of land in priority koala habitats in the Northern Rivers, through 20 conservation agreements.

Under the current NSW Koala Strategy, the NSW Government is continuing to deliver on-ground actions to protect koalas. Since March 2023, the NSW Government has purchased over 13,500 hectares of koala habitat, across 15 properties, for inclusion in the national parks system. From July 2022 to March 2025, the NSW Government has also permanently protected 12,900 hectares of koala habitat on private land through 202 new conservation agreements with private landholders and the Biodiversity Conservation Trust.

#### Next Steps

Actions within this strategy are long-term commitments and will continue to be delivered by a broad range of stakeholders in the full duration of this recovery plan. All koala managers will continue to identify and secure koala habitat. The ACT Government will progress actions aligned within this strategy through development of a new forward-looking Nature Conservation Strategy. The Queensland Government will continue to progress actions for koala habitat protection through the expansion of the private and public protected area estate and development of a new SEQ Koala Conservation Strategy.

| Description                                                                         | Status | Action                                                                                            |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | 3a     | Increase the overall area of protected koala habitat                                              |
|  | 3b     | Establish or expand existing targeted private or leasehold land incentive mechanisms and programs |
|  | 3c     | Investigate the potential to increase the protection of priority koala habitat                    |

## Strategy 4 – Integrate listed koala conservation into policy, statutory and land use plans

Action is needed to harmonise existing and future planning and policy settings, so that they contribute to the chances of long-term survival of koalas in the wild.

| Progress                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | Status                                                                                | Action | Description                                                                                                                           |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <p>Actions within this strategy have progressed over the last 12 months. Most jurisdictions in the listed range have completed reviews of key acts, or are beginning the process of drafting new cornerstone documents to set environmental standards and preserve koala habitats for generations to come.</p> <p>In July 2024, the NSW Government published the NSW plan for nature – in response to the statutory reviews of the <i>Biodiversity Conservation Act 2016 (BC Act)</i> and the native vegetation provisions of the <i>Local Land Services Act 2013</i>. The plan articulates the NSW Government’s ambition to put nature on a path to recovery and identifies priority legislative, policy and program directions to achieve this.</p> <p>The Queensland Government has prepared a biosecurity plan, updated the ARKS assessment for SEQ, and further invested in carbon farming projects in the region. The ACT government has published the Biodiversity Sensitive Urban Guidelines which provide guidance on how new developments can be designed to help protect and improve biodiversity and ecological connectivity. The Australian Government has continued the development of Known KHICC mapping highlighting the known range of climate-resilient populations, which can inform landscape-scale management decision making.</p> |    | 4a     | Review and update environmental impact guidance to support regulatory decision making                                                 |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |    | 4b     | Review, revise, and, where appropriate, strengthen statutory planning instruments and policies                                        |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |    | 4c     | Ensure identification and implementation of any offset decisions are strategic at a landscape scale and informed by the recovery plan |
|                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                          |    | 4d     | Incorporate the impacts of projected climate change into all strategic Koala planning and actions                                     |
| <p><u>Next Steps</u></p> <p>Actions within this strategy are wide ranging and ongoing. This will require consistent identification, revision, implementation and incorporation into future planning and policy settings within each jurisdiction. The ACT Government is progressing a review of the <i>Nature Conservation Act 2014</i> and development of a new Nature Conservation Strategy. The Australian Government’s continued development of the Known KHICC layers will help to make planning climate informed. The National Koala Recovery Team continues to develop targeted guidance for local governments and developers on urban design guidelines and the principles of landscape-scale management. Queensland Government is developing an Invasive Species Planning Toolkit which will assist local governments in integrating koala conservation into local biosecurity planning. A new SEQ Koala Conservation Strategy is being developed for release in 2026.</p>                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                      |  | 4e     | Develop national guidelines or standards for Koala-friendly urban design.                                                             |

## Mapping Known Koala Habitat in a Changing Climate

The koala's distribution is wide but fragmented. Modelling (Briscoe, 2016) shows, among other things, hotter climates will mean koalas might not get the moisture they need to survive from eucalyptus leaves – their main source of water.

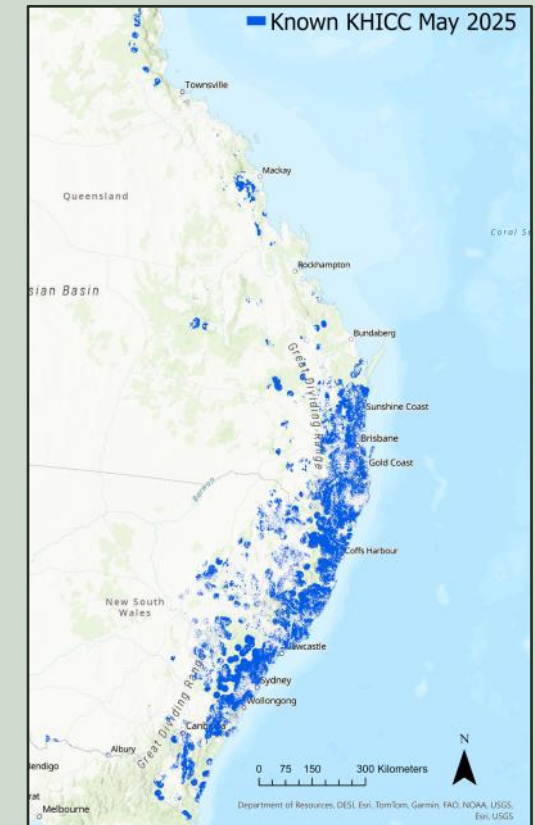
The recovery plan aims to identify where koalas will persist under threats from climate change, where populations can be connected to existing or new areas, and where isolated populations can be protected.

Environment Information Australia has produced a map which shows where known populations of koalas are likely to persist in a 2070 predicted climate, building on the Nationally Important Koala Areas created by the National Environmental Science Program.

This new mapping relies on 3 criteria:

- **Presence** - Has a koala been seen there within 10km since 2010?
- **Habitat** - Is it quality koala feed habitat or core habitat? (not just an area koalas pass through)
- **Climate** - Do climate models show koalas can survive there in 2070?

The map has been made available through the new Environment Information Australia portal. The map will increase transparency and availability of knowledge for local planners and conservationists to manage koalas at a landscape-scale in a climate smart way. Climate resilient decisions might include protecting climate resilient habitat or focussing on building microclimates in climate-impacted populations. Koalas are still impacted by extreme weather, dogs, road strike, and land clearing and these maps will inform more strategic impact investments in key habitat to allow recovery.



## Strategy 5 – Strategically restore listed koala habitat

Restoration increases the overall habitat available for koalas and increases the connectivity between areas of habitat, important for the long-term survival of listed koala populations. These actions aim to ensure that resources are targeted to the most strategic areas.

### Progress

Good progress has been made against the actions in this strategy over the past 12 months.

The National Koala Recovery Team has published [the Koala habitat restoration and revegetation resources](#) document, providing guidance to anyone wanting to carry out restoration or revegetation activities to support koala populations.

Investment and on-ground action to expand koala habitat projects continues in each jurisdiction. Recent reporting from the Australian Government Saving Koalas Fund indicates some 5,000 hectares of koala habitat has been created or improved, and 250,000 trees planted. Queensland Government have committed an additional \$8.5 million per annum, which will continue the delivery of the Koala Habitat Restoration Partnership Program, led by Queensland Trust for Nature (QTFN), and support the Restore and Reconnect: SEQ Koala Habitat project, delivered by Healthy Land & Water. Habitat restoration efforts under the NSW Koala Strategy has created or improved koala habitat across private and public land in NSW, through partnerships with regional and community organisations, including local Landcare groups and WWF Australia. These actions are strategically connecting protected land to maximise impact for koala conservation. The ACT government has also progressed actions in this strategy by implementing the Gula (Koala) on Ngunnawal Country project which seek to improve monitoring and restore habitat for Gula and other wildlife in the ACT.

### Next Steps

Habitat restoration requires consistent and sustained efforts guided by strategy. Over the next 12 months, focus will be on progressing actions to provide a lasting framework for koala habitat restoration. This will be done by revision of key documents such as the Nature Conservation Strategy (ACT), and by delivering on state-focused koala recovery strategies. Regional and community actors also have a continuing and important role to play in revegetating habitat at strategic and priority locations.

| Status                                                                              | Action | Description                                                                                                           |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|  | 5a     | Build on and implement landscape-scaled habitat restoration plans                                                     |
|  | 5b     | Develop and implement best practice revegetation and restoration guidelines appropriate to local conditions           |
|  | 5c     | Implement on-ground revegetation or restoration programs in previously cleared areas of koala habitat                 |
|  | 5d     | Improve the condition of existing Koala habitat on both private and public land through best-practice land management |



## Gold Coast Northern Koala Corridor

The Gold Coast Coomera-Pimpama population is one of 4 urban koala populations that continue to persist on the edge of a growing urban area. The population which is estimated to include approximately 265 koalas is being supported through strategic, landscape-scale management.

Loss of habitat has created smaller, fragmented patches which intensify threats to koalas such as disease, vehicle strikes, dog attacks and displacement. In response, the City of Gold Coast has implemented a targeted Northern Koala Corridor Plan. The City of Gold Coast aims to protect and restore between 1,150 and 1,500 hectares of core habitat. Over time, these areas will connect hinterland habitat to support the long-term viability of the Coomera-Pimpama koala population.

As part of this plan, 146 hectares of strategically-located land was acquired in December 2024 to link 2 existing conservation reserves. Restoration of the area will subsequently increase habitat availability, improve connectivity and enhance threat mitigation.

While individual land purchases may not yield immediate results for the local koala population, these strategic acquisitions - combined with on-ground conservation actions, management of parkland networks, and partnerships with private landholders and the state government - are driving meaningful progress. This landscape-scale, cross-tenure approach exemplifies how coordinated efforts can deliver tangible conservation outcomes for this important but threatened urban koala population.



*Photo: Aerial image of purchased site (centre) with the core koala habitat area (left), urban development of Coomera (right), the now connected park with restored koala habitat (far right).*

## Strategy 6 – Actively manage listed koala metapopulations

Metapopulation management relates to the movement of individuals and their genes between populations to maintain and potentially improve genetic diversity. It is a complex process. Management of fire, forest harvesting and human activities and developments all influence koala metapopulation processes and must be managed to mitigate adverse impacts.

### Progress

The National Koala Recovery Team continues to improve knowledge to progress these actions. Understanding of metagenomic processes and health is improving with whole-genome sequencing requiring less samples to get more information. However, indications show gene flow from northern to southern ranges, and across major infrastructure, is poor and likely to continue to decline.

The Queensland Government has extended funding to the SEQ Wildlife Hospital Network to coordinate the treatment and rehabilitation of koalas, while the NSW Government revised the code of practice for the care of injured and orphaned koalas. The Victorian Government has completed statewide koala population health and genetic surveys of the unlisted Victorian population, with the results finalised in March 2025. Learnings from the unlisted populations remain important for understanding koala population processes in listed populations.

Several recovery team members, led by Wildlife Health Australia, have commenced the development of *National guidance for the treatment and care of koalas in disasters*, with the establishment of a 21-member expert working group. While not directly related to genomic management, this guidance ensures koala care and interventions consider impacts on populations as a whole.

Across the listed range, there has been continued progress in fire management, with NGOs, regional delivery partners and state governments planning and delivering fire management actions to improve the health of the landscape's koalas depend on for population health. Work is underway, but information is not yet available at scale to confirm progress against actions 6c and 6d.

### Next Steps

Over the next 12 months, a technical group will develop guidance for translocation decisions. The recovery team will also consider the integration of genetics research and koala health metrics into the NKMP. Actions that support this strategy, including the analysis of genetic sampling undertaken through monitoring, will continue under the NSW Koala Strategy. The concept of a Living Koala Genome Bank in SEQ continues to be delivered by the Queensland Government, The University of Queensland, Queensland University of Technology, and Currumbin Wildlife Sanctuary to better understand and manage the genetics of the QLD koala metapopulation.

| Status                                                                               | Action | Description                                                                                                                         |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|   | 6a     | Develop meaningful and measurable metrics of health, genetics, population and distribution, and climate at relevant planning scales |
|   | 6b     | Develop national principles for conservation translocation decisions                                                                |
|   | 6c     | Regionally assess the feasibility, risks and cost-effectiveness of fire management options                                          |
|   | 6d     | Develop and implement fire management                                                                                               |
|  | 6e     | Develop and implement response and decision-support tools for individual and population management in emergencies                   |

# Appendix 1: Reference guide for summary assessment

## State/condition and prospects for long-term survival

How do you rate the state/condition of the species or ecological community and its prospects for long-term survival of the koala, based on current information? If there are limited data available, it may be appropriate to make a qualitative assessment based on expert assessment. The information below is a guide on how an assessment is made.

| State/condition grades                                                                                  | Criteria                                                                                                                                                                                                         |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <br><b>Very good</b>   | The species appears to have <b>very good</b> prospects for long term survival in the wild, based on an evaluation of the parameters such as abundance, distribution, habitat condition or the impact of threats. |
| <br><b>Good</b>        | The species appears to have <b>good</b> prospects for long term survival in the wild, based on an evaluation of the parameters such as abundance, distribution, habitat condition or the impact of threats.      |
| <br><b>Poor</b>      | The species appears to have <b>poor</b> prospects for long term survival in the wild, based on an evaluation of the parameters such as abundance, distribution, habitat condition or the impact of threats.      |
| <br><b>Very poor</b> | The species appears to have <b>very poor</b> prospects for long term survival in the wild, based on an evaluation of the parameters such as abundance, distribution, habitat condition or the impact of threats. |

## Conservation trajectory

What is the conservation trajectory of the species or ecological community in terms of whether it is improving, deteriorating, or stable? If possible, refer to the [national listing criteria for species and ecological communities](#) and make a determination of the conservation trajectory using at least one criteria.

| Recent trend                                                                                              | Criteria                                                                                                                         |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <br><b>Improving</b>     | Increase in the population or the geographic distribution of the species or ecological community, or another relevant parameter. |
| <br><b>Deteriorating</b> | Decrease in the population or the geographic distribution of the species or ecological community, or another relevant parameter. |
| <br><b>Stable</b>        | The population or the geographic distribution of the species or ecological community, or another relevant parameter are stable.  |
| <br><b>Unclear</b>       | There is insufficient information to make an estimate of the conservation trajectory of the species or ecological community.     |

## Level of confidence

What is your level of confidence in these estimates based on the available evidence and the consensus of experts?

| Level                                                                               | Criteria                                             |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------|
|  | Evidence and consensus too low to make an assessment |
|  | Limited evidence or limited consensus                |
|  | Adequate high-quality evidence and high consensus    |

## Appendix 2: Recovery team membership

### Strategic Groups

| <b>Board and Strategic Action and Coordination Group members</b>                        | <b><u>Sector</u></b>   |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------|
| Department of Climate Change, Energy, the Environment and Water (Australian Government) | Government             |
| NSW Department of Climate Change, Energy, the Environment and Water                     | Government             |
| First Nations Reference Group co-chairs                                                 | Traditional custodians |
| QLD Department of Environment, Tourism, Science and Innovation                          | Government             |
| CSIRO                                                                                   | Science                |
| NSW Local Land Services                                                                 | NRM                    |
| NRM Regions Queensland                                                                  | NRM                    |
| WWF Australia                                                                           | NGO                    |
| ACT Environment, Planning and Sustainable Development Directorate                       | Government             |
| SA Department for Environment and Water                                                 | Government             |
| VIC Department of Energy, Environment and Climate Action                                | Government             |

| <b>Additional Strategic Action and Coordination Group members</b> | <b><u>Sector</u></b> |
|-------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------|
| Reef Catchments                                                   | NRM                  |
| Healthy Land and Water                                            | NRM                  |
| Wildlife Health Australia                                         | NGO                  |
| Port Stephens Council                                             | Government           |
| Redland City Council                                              | Government           |
| Local Government Association of Queensland                        | Government           |

### Advisory Groups

|                                                                                                            |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>First Nations Reference Group</b>                                                                       |
| Traditional Owners and First Nations people from different groups in NSW and QLD                           |
| <b>Community Advisory Committee membership drawn from the follow categories(77 organisations in total)</b> |
| Landcare                                                                                                   |
| Wildlife hospitals                                                                                         |
| Koala advocacy organisations                                                                               |
| Research organisations                                                                                     |
| Local councils                                                                                             |
| Environmental professionals and consultants                                                                |
| Farming representative groups                                                                              |
| Wildlife care                                                                                              |
| Zoos                                                                                                       |



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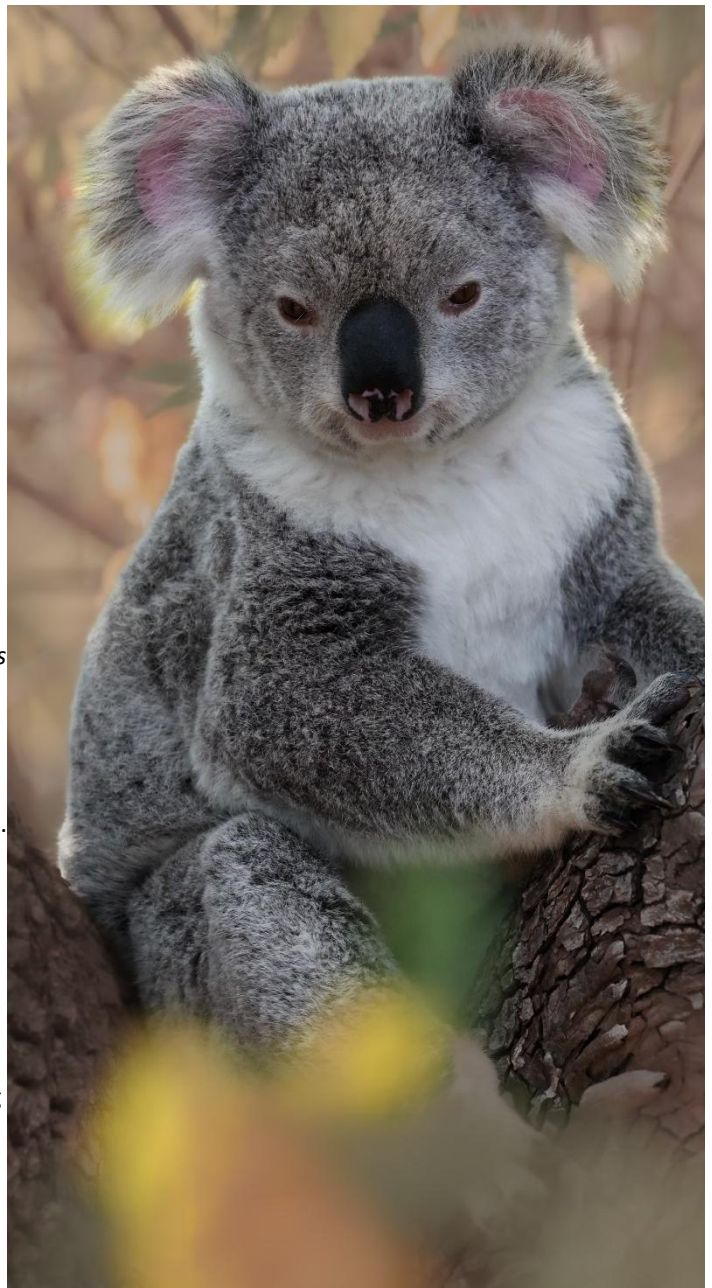
This publication is available on the [koala recovery team website](#).

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The National Koala Recovery Team is a collaboration of many dedicated partner organisations, coordinated by the Australian Government.

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